

Assignment 1

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story. (500- 650 words)

Assignment 2

- a) Winston Churchill believed, 'A joke is a very serious thing.' In about 200-300 words, tell us your favorite joke and try to explain the joke without ruining it.
- b) Vestigiality refers to genetically determined structures or attributes that have apparently lost most or all of their ancestral function, but have been retained during the process of evolution. In humans, for instance, the appendix is thought to be a vestigial structure. Describe something vestigial (real or imagined) and provide an explanation for its existence. (300-450 words)

Assignment 3

- a) The personal statement demonstrates your ability to write clearly and concisely on a selected topic and helps you distinguish yourself in your own voice. What do you want the readers of your application to know about you apart from courses, grades, and test scores? Having already been exposed to the first Common App essay prompt, choose an option from the rest that best helps you answer that question, using the prompt to inspire and structure your response. (450-650 words)
 - 1. The lessons we take from obstacles we encounter can be fundamental to later success. Recount a time when you faced a challenge, setback, or failure. How did it affect you, and what did you learn from the experience?
 - 2. Reflect on a time when you questioned or challenged a belief or idea. What prompted your thinking? What was the outcome?
 - 3. Describe a problem you've solved or a problem you'd like to solve. It can be an intellectual challenge, a research query, an ethical dilemma-anything that is of personal importance, no matter the scale. Explain its significance to you and what steps you took or could be taken to identify a solution.
 - 4. Discuss an accomplishment, event, or realization that sparked a period of personal growth and a new understanding of yourself or others.

5. Describe a topic, idea, or concept you find so engaging that it makes you lose all track of time. Why does it captivate you? What or who do you turn to when you want to learn more?

- b) The seven liberal arts in antiquity consisted of the Quadrivium - astronomy, mathematics, geometry, and music - and the Trivium - rhetoric, grammar, and logic. Describe your own take on the Quadrivium and the Trivium. What do you think is essential for everyone to know? (300-450 words)

Remember that your essay should portray an aspect of your personality, identity, character, or self.

Assignment 4

- a) What can actually be divided by zero? (500-650 words)
- b) “A man cannot be too careful in the choice of his enemies.” Oscar Wilde. Othello and Iago. Dorothy and the Wicked Witch. Autobots and Decepticons. History and art are full of heroes and their enemies. Tell us about the relationship between you and your arch-nemesis. (500-650 words)

Assignment 5

- a) Reflect on your engagement with a community to which you belong. How do you feel you have contributed to this community? (250-350 words)
- b) Provide details about your change in progression through secondary school (gap year). (250 words)
- c) Briefly elaborate on an extracurricular activity or work experience of significance to you. (250-500 words)
- d) Why are you drawn to your intended major and other areas of academic focus you wish to explore? (You may share a skill or concept that you found challenging and rewarding to learn, or any experiences beyond coursework that may have broadened your interest. (250 words)
- e) Other parts of your application give a sense of how you might contribute to (insert your desired school). But we also want to consider how (insert your desired school) will contribute to your interests and goals. Help us understand what aspects of (insert your desired school) appeal to you most, and how you’ll make use of specific resources and opportunities here. (450-650 words)